



Pokemon Go remote raids

Pokemon Go introduced remote raids which lets users attend raids while staying at home. <https://digit.in/may20-47>



Brothers in Arms TV series

Gearbox's WWII shooter, Brothers in Arms, will reportedly get its own TV show adaptation. <https://digit.in/may20-48>

Boo SE

Apple just announced the successor to one of its most popular models, but the lack of clarity on future releases cannot be good for its users.

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Apple just upgraded the iPhone SE, confirming rumours that have been circulating for over two years now.

However, the timing is just not right and considerate towards the buyers. Thing is, Apple is not doing anything to address the uncertainty that its users face when it comes to planning for the future. When we give buying advice for any product category to our readers, one thing that we always clear up first is having a clear upgrade path. Making a smart, informed and sensible decision involves knowing when you will be buying the next device, or getting the next upgrade, when the said device will be available, and a rough estimate of how much it will cost. The secretive nature of Apple means that users simply do not have the details necessary to make an informed decision.

For years, as long as Steve Jobs was at the helm, iPhones had a predictable tick-tock release cycle, or at least Apple users had the illusion of such predictability. First a device was launched, and then the updated S version the next year. However, the only device where the pattern was followed to the book was the iPhone 4. The iPhone 5 had a surprise c variant. The Plus variants began with the iPhone 6, which was

followed by the release of the SE. Still, till that point of time, it was possible to either buy a phone every year, or target the upgraded S versions every other year. After that, things went haywire.

The iPhone 8 followed the iPhone 7, and both did not get S versions. After that, Apple decided to skip ahead to the ridiculously-named iPhone X, with a new XR variant. The S versions were not skipped this time, but then came along the iPhone 11 which changed everything yet again. This time, there were Pro and Pro Max variants. The names of the iPhones are quickly approaching the obtuse names used by other companies, such as the Asus Zenfone Max Pro M2. Where is the minimaluminamilsim in this? At this point of time, it has become impossible to predict what the company will do next, but that is just one of the many problems that iPhone users have with the devices that they are invested in.

The first thing that we see, when we review a device, is build quality. One of the long term trends we are seeing with Apple devices is that the build quality is getting shoddier with every release. When the 3GS and 4 came out, it was unthinkable that there would ever be an iPhone that bends, or one where the paint coating flakes off! Yet, we have seen both of these things come to pass.

This is from the same company that made overnight changes in the assembly line by hiring thousands of workers to ensure that the glass does not get scratched by keys in the same pocket. How the mighty have fallen. This is not what Apple users have been paying for, or were primed to expect. It feels like a personal betrayal from the company.

When you make phones for mid-gets, go all in and give them the 4.5-inch screen they want. This was an extremely appealing aspect for SE users, especially those who wanted to invest in a secondary phone. Now a 4.7 inch screen is just not all in, and is sure to irritate those who have been patiently waiting to upgrade from the SE. Those who have used the SE as their daily driver will readily agree that the form factor of 8 is just not the same thing.

Then there is the problematic issue of the belly button, another thing that users had uncertainty over. The original vision for the device was one without any buttons on the screen, and of course, the notch. It was just a block of all screen. It took a while to replace the belly button, and we are perfectly happy with the screen. However, there are those who still prefer to use the devices with a physical home button, and these users were faced with a conundrum over the last few years. They would have to opt in for a new device without a belly button, or go ahead and buy a device that would become obsolete sooner. This was again, because there was no clarity or information available from the company. It would have been much better if in 2019 Diwali, Apple users were informed that in March 2020 there would be an upgrade to the SE, with a belly button.

Now, the taptic engine does its job incredibly well. It is just amazing how touching on-screen buttons actually gives the illusion of haptic feedback. The only place where this illusion fails is in the belly button, because there, you can actually know how buttons that actually click feel like. Kind of ironic, but considering the hipster crowd that the brand is popular in, maybe they dig it. We do not. 